

Patrick Ferguson

pcf44@cornell.edu · patrickcferguson.github.io

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Econometrics; partial identification; statistical decision theory under ambiguity; survey design

EDUCATION

Cornell University Expected 2027

PhD Economics

Committee: Jörg Stoye (Chair), Francesca Molinari, José Luis Montiel Olea

University College Dublin 2020

MSc Quantitative Economics

Trinity College, University of Dublin 2019

BA Economics and Psychology

JOB MARKET PAPER

Paying to Sharpen Identification: Optimal Probing of Coarse Data

Summary. I develop a framework for allocating costly refinement of coarse data to reduce identification uncertainty. For a broad class of expectation and distributional targets, identified-set diameter decomposes into observation-level contributions, yielding a simple rule: probe observations in decreasing order of expected diameter reduction per unit cost. I apply the rule to a survey-design problem.

WORKING PAPERS

Statistical Treatment Choice with Untested Doses

Asymptotic Minimax Optimality of Plug-In Rules

with José Luis Montiel Olea and Jörg Stoye

RESEARCH & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Research Assistantships

Francesca Molinari and Levon Barseghyan Summer 2025

Stephen Coate Summer 2023

Teaching Assistantships

Mathematical Economics (PhD) Fall 2022–2025

Economics of Wages and Employment (UG) Spring 2025

Microeconomic Theory II (PhD) Spring 2024

Intermediate Microeconomics (UG) Spring 2023

AWARDS

The Louis Walinsky Fund in Economics in Honor of Professor Herbert Joseph Davenport Outstanding Teaching Award	2023
Sage Fellow, Cornell University	2021–present
Denis Conniffe Medal, UCD — highest overall score in the MSc programme	2020

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: Irish

Software: LaTeX, R (proficient); Julia, Stata, MATLAB, Python (some experience).

REFERENCES

Jörg Stoye (Chair)

Ta-Chung Liu Professor of Economics
Cornell University
stoye@cornell.edu

Francesca Molinari

Professor, School of Government and Policy
Johns Hopkins University
fmolina4@jh.edu

José Luis Montiel Olea

Associate Professor of Economics
Cornell University
montiel.olea@gmail.com